METHODOLOGY & INTERVIEWEES

- **Our Goal:** To understand if yielding to pedestrians is a strict legal requirement or a cultural habit.
- **Interviewee 1 (Curtis):** A driver with 7 years of experience who took his test in downtown San Francisco.
- **Interviewee 2 (Jane):** A local driver familiar with driving dynamics in Berkeley and the Pacific Northwest.

CULTURAL FORCES: DEFENSIVE DRIVING

- **The Concept:** "Defensive driving" means letting others on the road react and make the first move.
- **Mutual Acknowledgment:** Pedestrians and drivers often wave hands at each other to show appreciation.
- **Power Dynamics:** The driver operates a heavy vehicle with greater power, bearing ultimate responsibility.

> *"When you have the greater power, you have to be more responsible with your action..."*

▶️ Play Interview Clip (Curtis)

POLITICAL FORCES: THE 2023 JAYWALKING LAW

- **The Policy:** California legalized jaywalking in 2023 when there is no immediate danger.
- **Driver Anxiety:** This policy increases risk, requiring drivers to be constantly alert.
- **Urban vs. Rural:** Drivers feel this rule is acceptable for empty highways but should be restricted in dense cities.

THEORY VS. LOCAL REALITY: THE BERKELEY EXPERIENCE

- **Late-Night Rush:** Drivers can become impatient and rush through intersections late at night.
- **Bold Pedestrians:** Young people and students in Berkeley often cross boldly, even with oncoming traffic.
- **Regional Shifts:** Drivers in the Northwest wait patiently, whereas downtown drivers act more rushed.

▶️ Play Interview Clip (Berkeley)

CONCLUSION

- **A Complex Intersection:** Yielding is a blend of traffic regulations and spontaneous community behavior.
- **Safety First:** The culture recognizes that safety takes precedence, reinforced by severe penalties.
- **Ongoing Evolution:** Traffic culture constantly balances driver efficiency with pedestrian freedom.